

income, as she had done before she got married, but Ben said they couldn't afford to do it. He was supported in that decision by both sets of parents, who felt it would be better to pay off some of the debts first.

For several months things seemed to get better financially, and her relationship with Ben even improved. They had some extra money to go out periodically, and Naomi was able to buy a used car so she would not be dependent on Ben to get back and forth to work.

Then Naomi began to feel nauseated in the mornings. When she missed her period, she wondered if she could be pregnant. She hadn't been disciplined about taking the birth control pills her doctor had prescribed. A home pregnancy test confirmed her suspicion: she was pregnant.

She thought about Ben's reaction and the fact that not only would a baby curtail her education, but would also greatly reduce her ability to work. She felt like she was in a box with no way out. The thought of an abortion briefly flitted through her mind, but she discarded it. Her strong Christian background would not allow her to do such a thing. But now she understood the terrible temptation that money pressures created for others who found themselves in the same situation.

"Pregnant? No!" Ben exclaimed when Naomi told him. "How could you be so stupid, Naomi? All you had to do was take your pills and you wouldn't have gotten pregnant."

"Do you think I got pregnant on purpose?" Naomi yelled back. "I don't like this any more than you do, but there is nothing I can do about it now."

Ben stormed out of their bedroom. Naomi collapsed on the bed in tears. She had always thought she'd be excited to become a mother, but this wasn't the right time. She felt guilty about getting pregnant and anxious about the future.

*How will we ever be able to pay for a baby? she wondered. If I stop working, we won't even be able to pay the bills we have now.*